Small Business Incident Response Checklist

A lightweight preparation and response guide for small teams.

Prepare

- Name an incident leader and backup contact.
- Maintain an asset list, critical supplier contacts and an offline copy of the response plan.
- Test backups and record recovery priorities for important services.

Detect and assess

- Capture who noticed the issue, when it began and which systems are affected.
- Classify the impact on operations, customers, data and legal obligations.
- Avoid destructive changes until evidence and scope are understood.

Contain and communicate

- Isolate affected accounts and systems using documented procedures.
- Use a separate trusted channel for incident coordination.
- Provide accurate updates and avoid speculation.

Recover and improve

- Restore in priority order and verify systems before normal use.
- Monitor closely for recurrence and rotate exposed credentials.
- Document lessons, owners and due dates for corrective actions.

Use this guide with your organisation's policies and incident contacts. For urgent events, follow the approved escalation path immediately.